

Michael Naidoo

UX / EXPERIENCE DESIGNER

User Experience and System Designer with an Honors-equivalent background (NQF 8) in digital interactions and behavioral design systems. Proficient at analyzing complex user interactions, building predictive system frameworks, and transforming manual data pipelines into automated digital solutions. Strong cross-functional leadership background with a deep focus on human-centered interaction.

EXPERIENCE

TRAINER LOGISCOOL SANDTON

Oct 2025 – Present

- Taught programming principals using Game Design as a fun, engaging medium
- Taught game design principals through play using Roblox as a teaching and development environment.
- Automated the lengthy class reflection administrative process saving trainers up to 24 minutes per class.

SECRETARY WITS SPORTS COUNCIL

Nov 2024 – Nov 2025

- Oversaw the administrative processes of the Wits Sports Council
- Increased interclub events by 300% over 2024.
- Finalised the first official constitution of the Wits Sports Council in almost a decade.

CHAIRMAN WITS TANG SOO DO CLUB

Nov 2023 - Nov 2024

- Oversaw all operations of the Wits Tang Soo Do club.
- Compared the club's operations to those of more successful clubs, resulting in:
 - > An increase of 50% in revenue generating events.
 - > An increase of 100% in member retention, leading to a 100% increase in club income from membership fees.

TRAINER

LOGISCOOL BEDFORDVIEW

Nov 2023 – Jan 2024

- Taught game design principals through play using Roblox as an interactive and engaging learning environment.
- Focused on using gaming and game design to facilitate learning for children with learning disabilities.

CONTACT

- michaelnaidoo04@gmail.com
- michael-naidoo.github.io
- 064-750-4175
- Randburg, GP
- <https://www.linkedin.com/in/michael-naidoo-74123b22a/>

EDUCATION

BA Digital Arts
University of the Witwatersrand
2022-2025 (Graduated – NQF IV 8)

CERTIFICATIONS

CS50 Introduction to Computer Science
University of Harvard via Edx
2026 (In Progress)

Master Data Analysis - Python & Machine Learning
Udemy
2026 (In Progress)

SKILLS

- C#
- Python
- HTML - CSS
- User Experience Design
- Interaction Design
- Data Analytics
- Willingness to Learn
- Decision Making Under Pressure
- Microsoft Office
- Predictive Modeling
- Attention to Detail

PROJECTS

Samurai Senshi (Unity)

Target Focus: Systems Design and Game Balancing

The Design Challenge: Designing a fast-paced, high-competitiveness 2D fighter that remains accessible to players across varying skill ceilings without alienating high-level players.

The System Innovation: Engineered a dynamic dynamic catch-up mechanic (a passive death-buff system) to systematically close the player skill gap.

The Iteration and Polish:

Problem: Initial playtests revealed that halting the match for a buff selection severely broke player immersion and ruined the game's high-velocity flow state.

Solution: Iterated on the temporal pacing by making the buff selection completely optional and non-blocking. Allowed the core gameplay loop to immediately transition to the next round, shifting agency to the losing player and maintaining a balanced skill-to-power ratio.

The Technical Execution: Programmed the entire gameplay framework in Unity (C#) outside of art assets, including the modular weapon attribute system and user interface layouts.

Social Glow (Unity)

Target Focus: Experience Design and Narrative Systems

The Design Challenge: Architecting a branching, choices-matter 3D narrative game designed to induce mechanical stress by forcing the player to constantly balance contrasting corporate AI approval vs peer approval indexes.

The System Innovation: Designed a dual-variable economic choice loop tracking shifting social capital across two opposing factors.

The Iteration and Polish:

Problem: User testing indicated that static text-based dialogue boxes failed to create high immersion or emotional resonance, leading to player detachment from the narrative stakes.

Solution: Restructured the experience flow by implementing a cyclic cadence, inserting interactive mini-games as progression gateways before dialogue sequences. This psychological shift in pacing increased active player investment and heightened the narrative's tension.

Wits Tang Soo Do Retention System

Target Focus: Corporate UX / User Retention Case Study

The Business Challenge: Resolving a severe post-COVID customer churn issue where early stage signups dropped drastically by 90% within the first 60 days of the yearly lifecycle.

The Methodology (Research): Executed a competitive analysis and heuristic evaluation of rival organizations to isolate user retention drivers. Discovered two distinct market archetypes: large legacy brands relying on name recognition, and small niche brands relying on high frequency community touchpoints.

The UX Intervention: Selected the community-centric model, mapping out a new user onboarding journey. Safely reactivated physical facilities (Clubhouse) and designed a structured 4-part social interaction framework during the critical drop-off window.

The Quantifiable Outcome: Successfully engineered a 100% increase in member retention by the march checkpoint, directly stabilizing long term organizational cash flow.

**TO VIEW ALL PROJECTS, VISIT MY WEBSITE AT
MICHAEL-NAIDOO.GITHUB.IO**